Unilever in the Global Economy, 2020–2025

BUSI 1763 Dynamics of Global Business · Group Mind Map · Data: 2020–2025

UNILEVER

UK-based consumer goods MNE
Turnover €50.5bn (2025)

Globalisation
Speaker 1

- Levitt: one world market
  5 drivers · markets + production
- ~190 countries · 3.4bn people use
  its products every day
- 59% of turnover from emerging
  markets (2025) · Europe only 19%
- 30 Power Brands = 78% of turnover
  280+ factories (2023)
- Risks: COVID (Mar 2020) · inflation 2022
  (prices +11.3%) · Russia exit (Oct 2024)

Regional Integration
Speaker 2

- 5 levels: FTA → customs union →
  common market → economic union
- Trade creation vs trade diversion
- Nov 2020: one UK parent company
  (UNCTAD: $81bn cross-border merger)
- USMCA (Jul 2020) → Mexico plant
  $800m (Apr 2025), exports to US & Canada
- RCEP (Jan 2022): Unilever Indonesia 85%
  AfCFTA (Jan 2021): Unilever Nigeria 76%

MNEs from Advanced Economies
Speaker 3

- 7 MNE goals vs 7 host-country goals
  creeping expropriation
- Ownership advantages: brands
  R&D €0.8–1.0bn a year
- India: Hindustan Unilever 61.9%
  buys Minimalist (Apr 2025)
- Conflict: 7,500 job cuts (Mar 2024)
  4,300 gone by Dec 2024
- Russia: stayed from Mar 2022,
  sold the business Oct 2024

FDI
Speaker 4

- OLI model + 4 motives
  greenfield vs M&A
- Greenfield: China €100m (Jun 2020)
  Mexico $800m (Apr 2025), 850 jobs
- M&A: Paula's Choice €1.8bn (Aug 2021)
  Dr. Squatch €1.2bn (Sep 2025)
- Sell: tea €4.6bn, gain €2.3bn (Jul 2022)
  Magnum demerger, gain €3.4bn (Dec 2025)
- World FDI: $1tn (2020) → $1.6tn (2025)

Sources: Unilever PLC Annual Reports on Form 20-F 2020–2025; UNCTAD World Investment Reports 2021 and 2026; full Harvard references on our presentation slides.